

ENGLISH LANGUAGE CURRICULUM

Complete O'Level & A'Level Syllabus Framework

Institution: Ejikeme Masterclass

Target Alignment: IGCSE, WAEC, Cambridge A-Level & STPM

Curriculum Architecture: This master document outlines a progressive 2-tier English Language curriculum. The **O'Level Framework** establishes essential grammatical fluency, structural mechanics, reading comprehension, and communicative precision. The **A'Level Framework** elevates learners to advanced linguistic analysis, sociolinguistic theory, stylistics, and original commentary.

PART 1: O'LEVEL ENGLISH LANGUAGE CURRICULUM

Module 1: Functional Grammar & Language Mechanics

1.1 Parts of Speech in Context

- **Nouns:** Concrete, abstract, collective, and uncountable nouns; grammatical number and case usages.
- **Verbs:** Transitive and intransitive verbs; modal auxiliaries for obligation, permission, and probability; subject-verb agreement (concord).
- **Adjectives & Adverbs:** Comparative and superlative forms, correct order of adjectives in noun phrases, adverbial modifiers.
- **Prepositions, Conjunctions & Pronouns:** Case alignment, relative and reflexive pronouns, coordinating and subordinating conjunctions.

1.2 Sentence Structure & Syntax

- **Clause Types:** Independent vs. dependent clauses (relative, adverbial, noun clauses).
- **Sentence Formations:** Constructing simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences for stylistic variety.
- **Error Analysis & Correction:** Eliminating dangling modifiers, run-on sentences, comma splices, and fragment sentences.

1.3 Punctuation & Mechanics

- **Punctuation Mastery:** Terminal punctuation, commas, semicolons, and colons in complex structures.
- **Possession & Contraction:** Correct placement of apostrophes in singular/plural possessives and contracted forms.
- **Direct Speech & Quotation:** Standard quotation mark rules, dialogue attribution, and inline citations.
- **Formatting & Typography:** Capitalization rules, hyphenation compound rules, and parenthetical elements (dashes, brackets).

Module 2: Reading Comprehension & Information Literacy

2.1 Literal & Inferential Comprehension

- **Explicit Analysis:** Identifying explicit facts, details, and main ideas in narrative and informational texts.
- **Implicit Analysis:** Drawing implicit conclusions, reading between the lines, and determining contextual meaning.
- **Authorial Perspective:** Evaluating author's purpose, tone, bias, attitude, and rhetorical strategy.

2.2 Vocabulary in Context

- **Contextual Clues:** Decoding unfamiliar terminology using synonyms, antonyms, and restatements.
- **Morphology:** Etymological structures, prefixes, suffixes, and Latin/Greek roots.
- **Lexical Nuance:** Distinguishing denotation (literal meaning) from connotation (associated meaning).

2.3 Textual Features & Non-Continuous Texts

- **Organizational Patterns:** Recognizing cause-effect, problem-solution, compare-contrast, and chronological text layouts.
- **Multimodal Data Analysis:** Interpreting non-continuous elements (charts, infographics, tables) alongside prose text.

2.4 Summary & Synthesis Skills

- **Information Filtering:** Distinguishing essential core arguments from non-essential illustrative details.
- **Paraphrasing Integrity:** Restating information in original phrasing while avoiding plagiarism.
- **Concise Composition:** Writing structured summaries under strict word count constraints.

Module 3: Composition & Directed Writing

3.1 Descriptive & Narrative Writing

- **Figurative Language:** Employing sensory imagery, metaphor, simile, personification, and metonymy.
- **Narrative Arc:** Structuring narrative pacing, plot progression, characterization, and atmospheric settings.
- **Stylistic Delivery:** Applying "Show, Don't Tell" principles and varied perspective control.

3.2 Discursive & Argumentative Writing

- **Thesis Formulation:** Constructing clear, defensible central propositions.
- **Argument Development:** Building logical chains of reasoning supported by evidence and concrete examples.
- **Refutation Techniques:** Incorporating counterarguments and executing balanced rebuttals.

3.3 Functional & Task-Based Writing

- **Formal Correspondence:** Official letters, emails, and petitions following proper layout and register.
- **Reports & Proposals:** Formatting, subheadings, objective tone, and actionable recommendations.
- **Journalistic Writing:** Articles for newspapers, magazines, and digital school platforms.
- **Rhetorical Speeches:** Utilizing rhetorical devices (ethos, pathos, logos, rule of three, rhetorical questions).

PART 2: A'LEVEL ENGLISH LANGUAGE CURRICULUM

Module 1: Advanced Linguistic Frameworks

1.1 Phonetics, Phonology & Prosodics

- **Phonetic Transcription:** The International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) and classification of consonants/vowels.
- **Connected Speech Dynamics:** Assimilation, elision, insertion, and linking sound patterns.
- **Prosodic Features:** Pitch inflection, intonation contours, stress placement, rhythm, and speech tempo.

1.2 Morphology & Lexicology

- **Morphemic Structure:** Free, bound, inflectional, and derivational morphemes.
- **Lexical Innovation:** Etymology, compounding, blending, acronyms, clipping, and neologisms.
- **Semantic Organization:** Semantic fields, collocational frameworks, and lexical cohesion chains.

1.3 Advanced Syntax & Grammar Analysis

- **Constituent Analysis:** Parsing noun phrases, verb phrases, prepositional phrases, and clause trees.
- **Information Packaging:** Passive voice transformation, fronting, cleft sentences, and extraposition for topic emphasis.
- **Structural Cohesion:** Anaphora, cataphora, ellipsis, and connective markers across extended discourse.

1.4 Semantics & Pragmatics

- **Sense Relations:** Hyponymy, hypernymy, antonymy, synonymy, polysemy, and homonymy.
- **Gricean Pragmatics:** The Conversational Maxims (Quantity, Quality, Relation, Manner) and Conversational Implicature.
- **Speech Act Theory:** Analyzing Locutionary, Illocutionary, and Perlocutionary speech acts (Austin & Searle).
- **Politeness Theories:** Face-Threatening Acts (FTAs), Positive/Negative Face, and Politeness Strategies (Brown & Levinson).

Module 2: Textual Analysis & Stylistics

2.1 Analyzing Spoken Discourse

- **Transcription Conventions:** Decoding micro/macro pauses, overlaps, pitch movements, and fillers.
- **Interactional Mechanics:** Turn-taking strategies, floor management, adjacency pairs, and repair mechanisms.
- **Spontaneity Features:** False starts, non-fluency features, hedge words, and discourse markers.

2.2 Analyzing Written & Multimodal Texts

- **Genre Conventions:** Analyzing structural layouts, expectations, and subversions across genres.
- **Visual Semiotics:** Typography, spatial distribution, color framing, and image-text interplay.
- **Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA):** Deconstructing ideology, power dynamics, representation, and audience positioning.

2.3 Stylistic Analysis & Comparative Textual Study

- **Stylistic Mechanics:** Foregrounding, linguistic deviation, structural parallelism, and patterning.
- **Narrative Perspective:** Authorial stance, point-of-view focalization, and narrative distance.
- **Comparative Methods:** Side-by-side linguistic comparison of texts across modes, historical eras, or media platforms.

Module 3: Language Variation, Change & Context

3.1 Language Acquisition & Development

- **Developmental Stages:** Phonological, lexical, syntactic, and pragmatic milestones in child language acquisition (CLA).
- **Theoretical Perspectives:** Nativism (Chomsky), Behaviorism (Skinner), Social Interactionism (Vygotsky, Bruner), Cognitive Theory (Piaget).
- **Multilingualism:** Second Language Acquisition (SLA) processes, interlanguage, and bilingual development.

3.2 Language in Society (Sociolinguistics)

- **Sociolinguistic Variation:** Regional dialects, urban accents, sociolects, and Received Pronunciation (RP).
- **Identity & Demographics:** Language interplay with gender, social class, age, and ethnicity.
- **Accommodation & Switching:** Code-switching, code-mixing, and Communication Accommodation Theory (Giles).
- **Global Englishes:** World Englishes framework, Kachru's Three Circles model, and English as a Lingua Franca (ELF).

3.3 Language Change Over Time

- **Historical Epochs:** Linguistic shifts across Old, Middle, Early Modern, and Present-Day English.
- **Drivers of Transformation:** Technological innovation, cultural contact, migration, globalization, and social status.
- **Attitudinal Debates:** Prescriptivism vs. Descriptivism, language decay myths, and standardization processes.

Module 4: Original & Craft Writing (Stylistics in Practice)

4.1 Writing for Specific Audiences & Media

- **Persuasive & Media Copy:** Crafting persuasive editorials, promotional text, and investigative journalism.
- **Creative Prose:** Developing fiction narratives, travel memoirs, and biographical profiles.
- **Transmedia Adaptation:** Adapting prose content across various target demographics and digital formats.

4.2 Metalinguistic Reflective Commentary

- **Analytical Self-Evaluation:** Explaining original linguistic and stylistic choices using formal metalanguage.
- **Strategic Alignment:** Justifying how specific phonological, lexical, and syntactic choices fulfill targeted communicative outcomes.

ASSESSMENT FRAMEWORK MATRIX

Level	Assessment Component	Core Assessment Focus & Skill Set
O'Level	Paper 1: Reading & Comprehension	Evaluating unseen informational/narrative passages, explicit details, inference, vocabulary, and summary writing.
O'Level	Paper 2: Writing & Composition	Assessing task-based directed writing (letters, reports, speeches) and original compositions (narrative, argumentative).
A'Level	Paper 1: Language Analysis	Linguistic analysis of unseen spoken/written texts, comparative study, and structural stylistics.
A'Level	Paper 2: Language Concepts	Evaluating theoretical mastery in Child Language Acquisition, Sociolinguistics, and World Englishes.
A'Level	Paper 3: Craft of Writing	Production of original creative/persuasive text accompanied by an in-depth metalinguistic commentary.